



Windows 7 pricing made public - \$319.99 for Windows 7 Ultimate, 299.9 for Professional and 199.99 for Home Premium



AMD's 785G chipset uses the DirectX 10.1 supported Radeon 4200 GPU



WD My Book Studio Edition II 4TB

It's HUGE!

kg, so it's not ideal to carry very often. Four connectivity options are available – Firewire 800, Firewire 400, USB and eSATA.

The speciality of this drive is that it supports RAID-0 & RAID-1. RAID-0 makes the entire 4 TB usable. We haven't

In April this year, we tested a large number of hard drives. In the category of external desktop drives, the 2 TB WD My Book Studio Edition II was pretty good. We now have with us the WD My Book Studio Edition II External 4TB Hard Drive.

This is a huge drive mind you – it weighs around 2.63

seen too many drives that require drivers, but this one does for the RAID function. When you first connect it, you need to install the driver and then set the RAID configuration.

There was nothing spectacular with the test results. The read burst speed was higher with the RAID-1 configuration with both

connection interfaces – USB and Firewire. With our file transfer tests, we found the average read and write speeds to be similar with both RAID configurations. The 1 GB Photoshop scratch test showed a big difference in file transfer. With RAID-0, the speed was twice as good as RAID-1, as you would expect. With Firewire, the performance was around 10% better than with USB.

The 4 TB WD My Book Studio Edition II only works with Windows Vista due to capacity restrictions of previous Windows operating systems. Using RAID-0 is recommended, but if your data is very important, RAID-1 is the way to go.

Contact

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Price: Rs. 39,000

Specifications

Capacity: 4 TB
Interface: Firewire 800
Firewire 400, USB 2.0 and eSATA
Dimensions: 166 x 98 x 154mm
Weight: 2.63 kg

RATINGS

Features8
Performance7
Build Quality6
Value for money5
Overall6.5

HP Photosmart C8188

Print and scribe

The HP Photosmart C8188 has memory card slots and a lightscribe CD/DVD drive. Not only does this printer read from CDs, but it can also

print labels directly onto the face of the CD or DVD. There is a 3.5 inch touch screen with an easy interface, that somewhat resembles a Windows XP theme. Like the Epson Photo Stylus TX700W, this too has Ethernet,

WiFi, and also comes with Bluetooth, so almost any phone or laptop can shoot out prints without the hassles of wired connectivity.

Some detail on our first test image was lacking and also the overall colour tone of the print was on the warmer side. The second test image was more balanced, but again, a few details with regard to the textures were missing here and there. The Combi document, consisting of text and images, showed smooth and readable text and well distinguished colours in the images.

The HP Photosmart C8188 costs Rs. 24,615, which may seem pricey, but if you do need a feature rich photo printer with all connectivity options including an optical drive that can read your digital media, then this is something you should buy.

Contact

Hewlett-Packard India Pvt. Ltd.
Phone: 30304499
Email: bharat.kharbanda@hp.com
Web site: www.hp.com/in
Price: Rs. 24,615

Specifications

Input capacity: Upto 100 sheets (A4)
Print quality: 4800 x 1200 dpi
Scan quality: 9600 x 9600 dpi
Dimensions: 448 x 392 x 216 mm
Weight: 11.4 kg

RATINGS

Features8.5
Performance7.5
Build Quality8
Value for money7
Overall8

